



Get free local jobs from Google

Your Google Business Profile — set-up & optimisation checklist

When a builder or homeowner in Carlisle searches “**scaffolding near me**” or “**scaffolders Cumbria**”, Google shows a map with 3 firms at the top. Those 3 get the enquiries — **for free**, before anyone scrolls to the paid ads. This guide gets How High Scaffolding into that top 3. It's the cheapest leads you'll ever get: no ad budget, no per-click cost. Work through it once, then spend 5 minutes a week keeping it active.

1 Claim & verify your profile

- Go to **google.com/business** and sign in with the How High Scaffolding Google account.
- Search for **How High Scaffolding** — if a profile already exists, claim it; if not, create it.
- Google verifies by **postcard, phone or video**. Do this first — nothing shows publicly until you're verified.

2 Fill in every single field

Google ranks complete profiles above half-finished ones. Leave nothing blank.

- **Business name:** How High Scaffolding — *exactly as registered, no keyword stuffing (against Google's rules)*
- **Phone:** 07944 362 960
- **Website:** <https://howhighscaffolding.co.uk>
- **Address / service area:** set How High as a **service-area business** covering Carlisle + surrounding Cumbria (Penrith, Brampton, Wigton, Workington, Longtown).
- **Hours:** set your **real working hours** — Google flags “open now”, and accurate hours mean you catch the early-morning trade calls.

3 Pick the right categories

- **Primary category:** **Scaffolder**
- **Secondary categories:** **Scaffolding service** **Construction company**

The primary category is one of the biggest ranking factors — get it exactly right.

4 Add real photos (this matters more than people think)

- Upload **15–20 real job photos** — residential and commercial scaffolds, roof-access towers, temporary roofs, chimney access, and the team on site.
- Add a **logo** and a **cover photo**.
- Add a few photos **every couple of weeks** — active profiles rank higher and look trustworthy.

Builders judge a scaffolder on clean, safe, well-built jobs. You already have 60+ real project photos from the website — reuse the best of them here.

5 Write a keyword-rich description & services

- In the **description**, naturally mention: *residential & commercial scaffolding, roof-work access, temporary roofs, chimney & gable access, new builds, renovations, fully insured, CISRS-trained, Carlisle & Cumbria*.
- Add each of those as a separate **Service** with a short sentence — they show on your profile and help you appear for those searches.
- List your **insurance & CISRS** credentials — they win the bigger commercial and contractor jobs.

6 Reviews — the #1 ranking factor

More reviews = higher ranking *and* more enquiries. Make asking part of every job strike.

How to do it the easy way

- In your profile, copy your “**review link**” (Google gives you a short link).
- Text it to the builder or homeowner when the scaffold's struck and they're happy.
- **Reply to every review** — even a one-line thank-you. Google rewards it.

Copy-paste text to send customers:

“Cheers for the job — glad the scaffold did the business! If you've got 30 seconds, a quick Google review really helps us out as a local firm. Here's the link: [your review link]. Thanks, the How High team.”

Target: aim for your first **10 reviews** fast, then a steady trickle. Repeat builders leaving reviews is gold — even 15–20 puts you ahead of most local scaffolders.

7 Post updates (like a free mini-Facebook)

- Use **Google Posts** to share a recent scaffold, a “taking bookings for [month]” notice, or availability for quick turnarounds.
- One post a week keeps the profile active — Google favours active profiles.

8 Turn on messaging & answer questions

- Enable **messaging** so builders can text you straight from Google for a price.
- Seed the **Q&A** section yourself: “Do you do domestic and commercial?” → “Yes — residential and commercial scaffolding across Carlisle & Cumbria, fully insured.”

Your 5-minute weekly routine

- **Ask** every customer that week for a Google review (send the text).
- **Reply** to any new reviews.
- **Add** 1–2 fresh job photos.
- **Post** one update (a job done, availability, or a notice).
- **Check** your “insights” — how many people called or asked directions.

Do this and within a few weeks you'll be getting calls from Google you didn't pay a penny for — on top of the website and word of mouth.